



The Friendship Baptist Church

The Church That Christ Built

ONLINE GIVING · ACCOUNT SETUP

Step 1 — Create the Church's Stripe Account

Prepared for the Church Treasurer • by Integrity Web Creations

Our church website is ready to receive **online tithes, offerings, and donations**. To turn this on, the church needs its own free account with **Stripe** — the trusted, secure company that processes the card payments and deposits every gift directly into the **church's bank account**. This one page walks you through creating that account. It takes about **20–30 minutes**. Once it's done, our web team handles all of the technical connection for you — you only need to complete the steps below.

Before you begin — have these ready

- ☐ The church's **legal name**, exactly as it appears on IRS documents
- ☐ The church's **EIN** (Employer Identification Number)
- ☐ The church's **IRS 501(c)(3) determination letter** (a PDF or clear photo)
- ☐ The church **bank account & routing numbers** (where donations will be deposited)
- ☐ A **church email address** the church controls long-term (e.g., info@thefriendshipbaptist.com) — *not* a personal email
- ☐ The church **mailing address and phone number**
- ☐ An **authorized representative's** personal details — legal name, date of birth, home address, and Social Security Number

WHY A SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER?

Federal law requires payment processors to confirm a real person is responsible for every account. The representative should be someone the church authorizes — typically the **Pastor, Treasurer, or a Trustee**. Their information is used only to verify identity; it does **not** make the funds personal — **all donations go to the church's bank account**. This is entered directly and securely on Stripe's own website and should never be shared with anyone by email.

Create the account — step by step

- 1 **Go to stripe.com** and choose “**Create account**” (or “Start now”).
- 2 **Set up the login.** Enter the **church email address** and create a **strong password**. Save it somewhere safe for the church — do not email it to anyone.
- 3 **Verify the email.** Open the confirmation message from Stripe and click the link inside.
- 4 **Turn on two-step verification (2FA)** when prompted. This protects the church's money. Use the church phone number or an authenticator app.
- 5 **Choose the business type.** Select “**Nonprofit organization,**” country **United States**.
- 6 **Enter the organization details:**
 - **Legal name** — exactly as on the IRS letter
 - **EIN**
 - **Website** — <https://thefriendshipbaptist.com>
 - **Address & phone** — the church's
 - **Industry** — choose “Religious organizations” (or “Charities / non-profits”)
- 7 **Enter the account representative** — the authorized person's legal name, date of birth, home address, and SSN, entered directly into Stripe's secure form.
- 8 **Add the payout bank account** — the church's **routing number** and **account number**. This is where gifts are deposited. Double-check every digit.
- 9 **Set the statement descriptor** — the short name donors see on their bank statement. Use something clear like “**FRIENDSHIP BAPTIST**” (about 22 characters max).
- 10 **Describe what you collect** — for example, “Charitable donations, tithes, and offerings for a religious nonprofit.”
- 11 **Submit for verification.** Stripe may ask you to upload the 501(c)(3) letter or an ID to confirm identity — have it ready. Approval is usually quick but can take 1–2 business days.
- 12 **Apply for the nonprofit discount.** Once the account is active, search “**nonprofit**” in the Stripe dashboard (or visit stripe.com/nonprofit-discount) and submit the 501(c)(3) letter. This lowers the processing fee to the reduced nonprofit rate.

FINAL STEP — HAND OFF TO YOUR WEB TEAM

Invite Integrity Web Creations (don't do the “developer” steps yourself)

Once the account is created and verified, simply invite us so we can safely connect the website — you'll never have to email us any sensitive keys:

- In Stripe, go to **Settings** → **Team** (or “Team and security”) → “**New member / Invite.**”
- Set the role to **Developer** (or Administrator).
- Send the invite to the address below, then let us know — we'll finish the connection and run test gifts before anything goes live.

Invite: aaronsmalls2010@gmail.com

DO

- Use a **church-controlled email** as the account owner
- Turn on **two-step verification**
- Keep the login in a **safe church record**
- Enter your SSN **only on stripe.com** (look for the padlock)

DON'T

- **Email** your password or any Stripe “keys” to anyone
- Use a **personal** email as the account owner
- Share your **SSN** with the web team or by message
- Attempt the technical “API / webhook” steps yourself

QUESTIONS? WE'RE GLAD TO HELP

You do not have to do this alone. Integrity Web Creations can walk through it with you on a call — reach **Aaron Smalls** at aaronsmalls2010@gmail.com.